

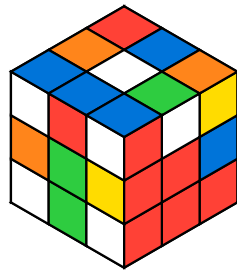
# The "magic-cubes" package

v0.0.1      MIT

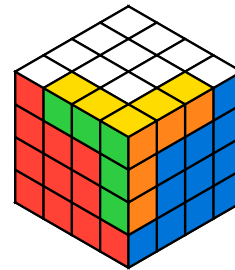
Represent Rubik's cubes of arbitrary size and apply algorithms to them

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 @RodAlc24



U' L' U' F' R2 B'  
R F U B2 U B' L  
U' F U R F'



F U2 L F L' B L  
U B' R' L' U R' D'  
F' B R2

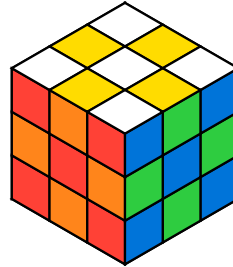
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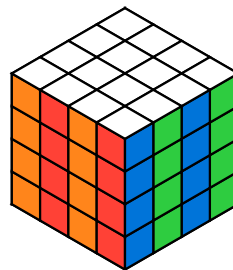
# Part I

## Examples

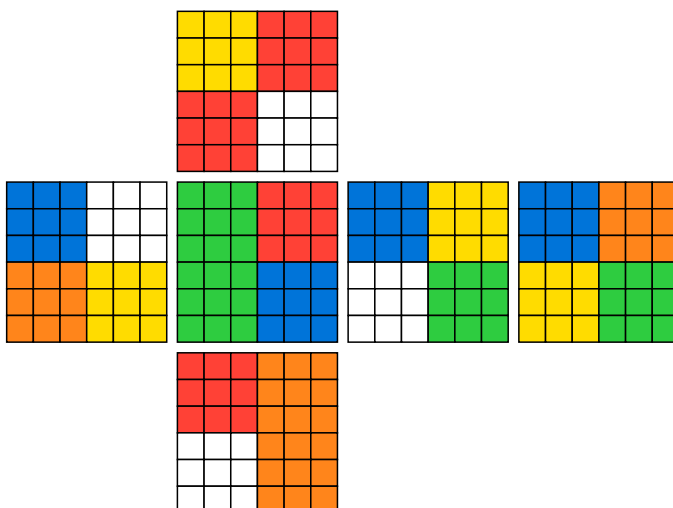
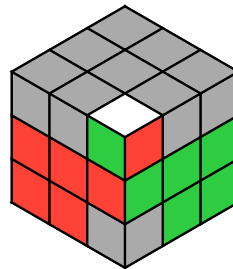
```
#draw_cube(
  apply(
    cube(),
    "F2 B2 R2 L2 U2 D2"
  )
)
```



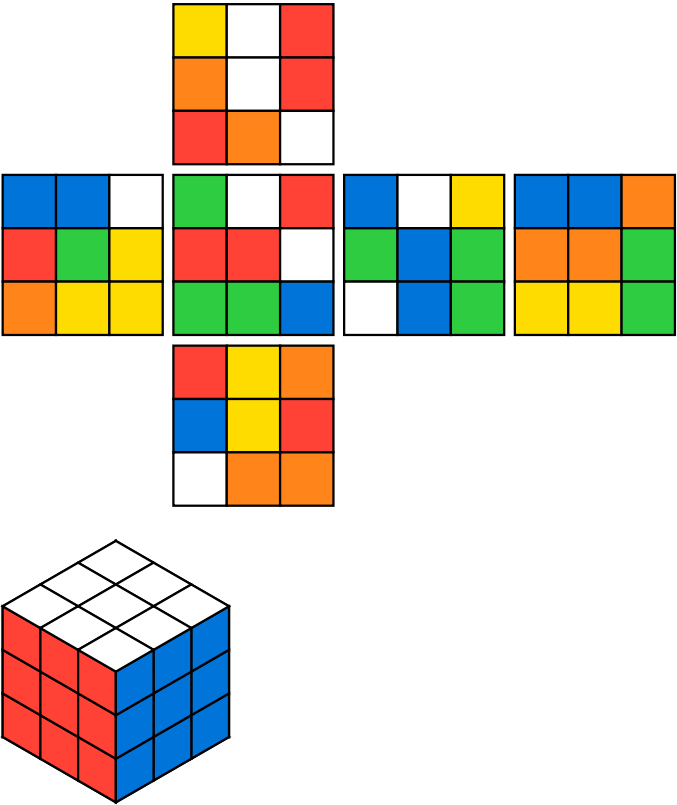
```
#draw_cube(
  apply(
    cube(size: 4),
    "R2 3R2 F2 3F2 R2 3R2"
  )
)
```



```
#draw_cube(
  apply(
    inverted: true,
    f2l-cube,
    "R2 U R2 U R2 U2 R2"
  )
)
```



I Examples



# Part II

## Guide

### II.1 Creating cubes

A cube is represented as a dictionary, and can be easily created with the `#cube` function. It should not be created or modified manually.

The size of the cube can be specified with the `(size)` argument (default is 3). The face colors can be changed with the `(colors)` argument, specifying the faces to change. The default colors are:

```
(  
  f: red,  
  r: blue,  
  u: white,  
  b: orange,  
  l: green,  
  d: yellow  
)
```

This colors are the Typst [predefined colors](#)<sup>1</sup>.

It is also possible to specify a face manually, in that case the corresponding value in `(colors)` is ignored. When specifying the colors manually, all the pieces in the face must be determined.

The order of the pieces in a face is the following:

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
|   |   |   | 0 | 1 | 2 |   |   |   |
|   |   |   | 3 | 4 | 5 |   |   |   |
|   |   |   | 6 | 7 | 8 |   |   |   |
| 0 | 1 | 2 | 0 | 1 | 2 | 0 | 1 | 2 |
| 3 | 4 | 5 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 6 | 7 | 8 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 6 | 7 | 8 |
|   |   |   | 0 | 1 | 2 |   |   |   |
|   |   |   | 3 | 4 | 5 |   |   |   |
|   |   |   | 6 | 7 | 8 |   |   |   |

Each face is represented with the default color previously explained, except the up face that is in black.

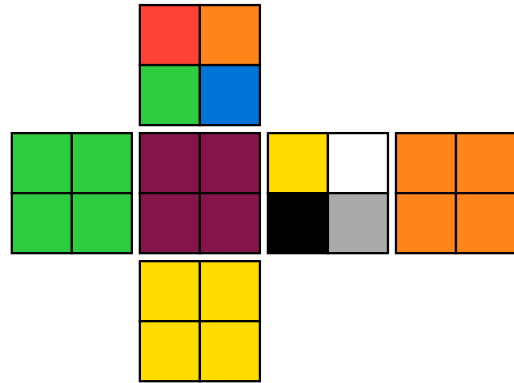
---

<sup>1</sup><https://typst.app/docs/reference/visualize/color/#predefined-colors>

Note that this way of creating cubes may result in an impossible cube state (you can even use more than six colors!). This can be useful, for example, to add a gray color to the non relevant pieces.

This order is also used in other size cubes, for example, if we want to create a 2x2x2 cube with a custom color in front face and custom up and right faces we can do:

```
#draw_flat(
  length: 45pt,
  cube(
    size: 2,
    colors: (f: maroon),
    stickers: (
      u: (
        red,
        orange,
        green,
        blue,
      ),
      r: (
        yellow,
        white,
        black,
        gray,
      ),
    ),
  )
)
```



There are also some useful predefined cubes: f2l-cube and oll-cube.

```
#draw_cube(f2l-cube, length: 30pt)
```



```
#draw_cube(oll-cube, length: 30pt)
```

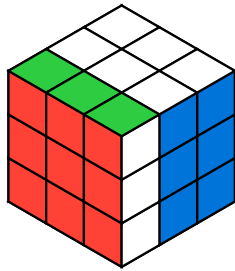


## II.2 Applying algorithms

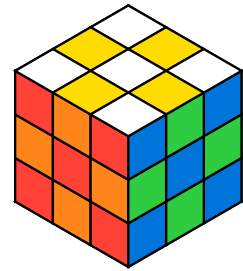
One of the main features of **MAGIC-CUBES** is the possibility to apply algorithms to the cubes. Algorithms are written following the standard notation that is fully documented on [Section III](#).

The function `#apply` receives a cube and an algorithm as a `str`. It is also possible, through the `(inverted)` argument to apply the inverse algorithm. This results in a cube that, after applying the specified algorithm, will result in the original cube.

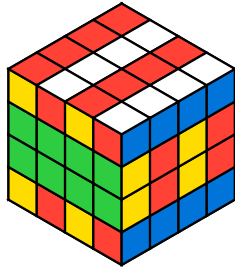
```
#draw_cube(
  apply(
    cube(),
    "F"
  )
)
```



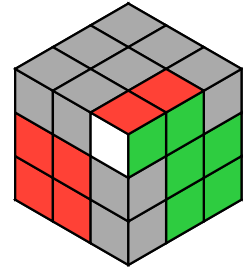
```
#draw_cube(
  apply(
    cube(),
    "M2 E2 S2"
  )
)
```



```
#draw_cube(
  apply(
    cube(size: 4),
    "2R L' 2-3u'"
  )
)
```



```
#draw_cube(
  apply(
    f2l-cube,
    inverted: true,
    "U R U' R'"
  )
)
```



There are also two alternative functions that lets you modify the cube: `#rotate_layer` and `#rotate_cube`.

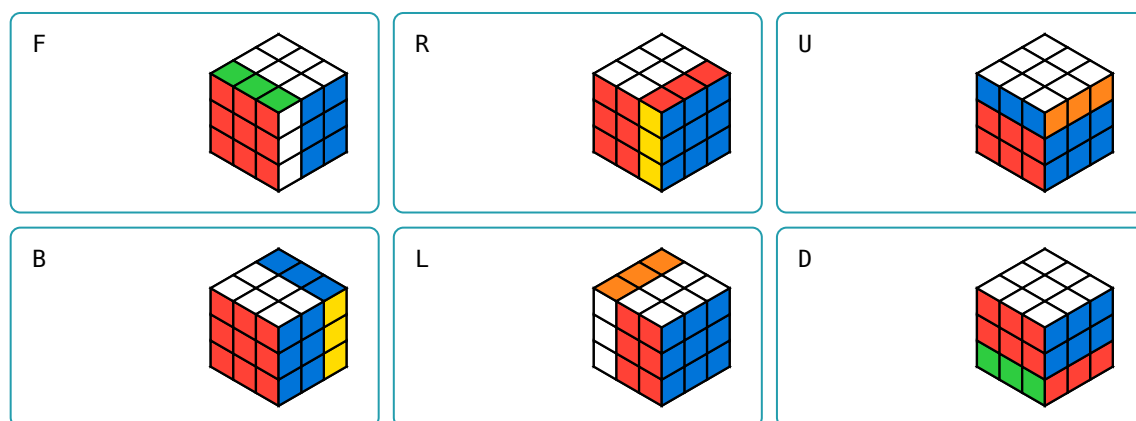
## II.3 Rendering cubes

## Part III

# Cube notation

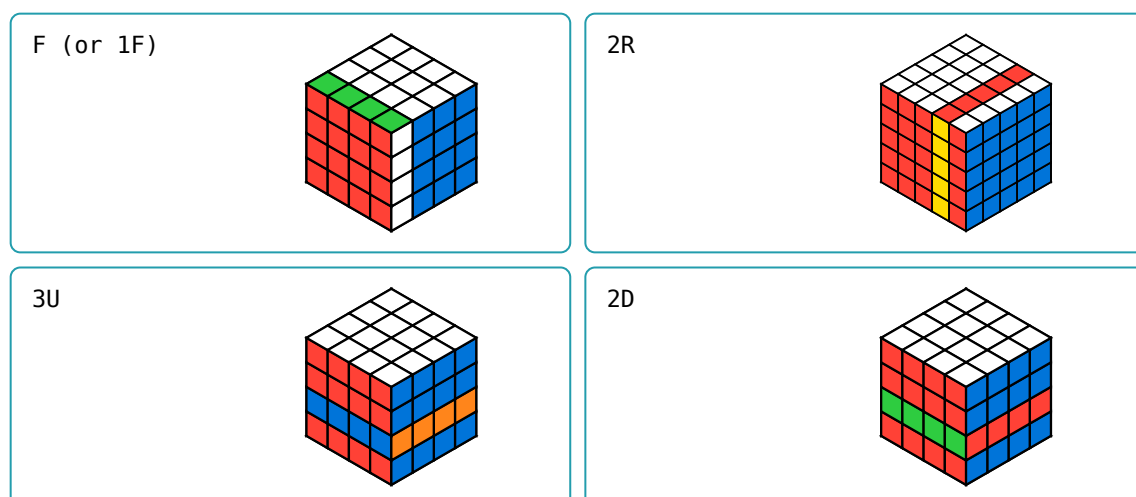
### III.1 1-layer moves

The basic moves are represented with one uppercase letter. There are six moves, one for each face of the cube: **F** (front), **R** (right), **U** (up), **B** (back), **L** (left) and **D** (down). Each represents a single clockwise rotation. Double and counterclockwise rotations are explained in [Section III.5](#).



It is also possible to move an inner layer. To do so, precede the letter with the depth of the layer. The outermost layer has a depth of 1 and layer numbering always starts from the referenced face.

The maximum depth is the cube size minus 1. If you want to rotate the opposite face use the corresponding notation, i.e., in a 4x4x4 cube a 4F rotation is not allowed, the correct notation is B'.

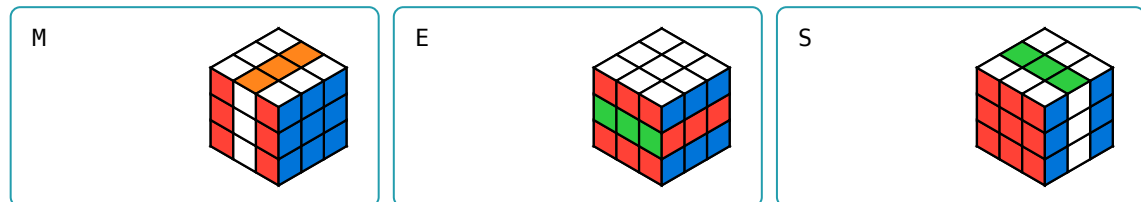


It is not necessary to specify the depth for the moves of the outermost layer. For example, 1U is equivalent to U in all cubes.

## III.2 Central moves

The central layers have a special notation:

- **M**: “middle”, between L and R following L.
- **E**: “equator”, between U and D following D.
- **S**: “standing”, between F and B following F.



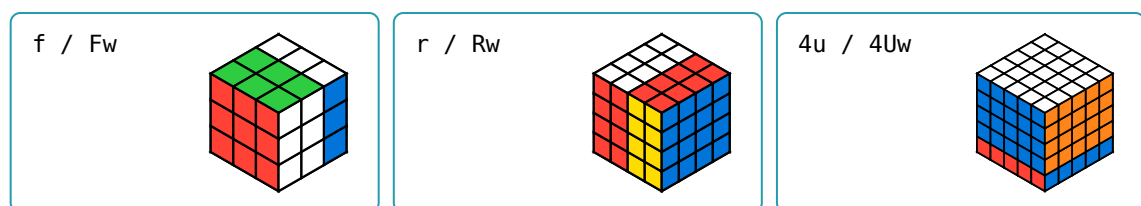
Central moves are only available on cubes with odd size.

## III.3 Wide moves

It is also possible to rotate more than one layer at the same time. This is especially useful for big cubes, but it is also used sometimes on a 3x3x3.

There are two equivalent notations: using lowercase letters or appending a **w** after the corresponding uppercase letter. By default, all layers between the outermost layer and the center (if the cube has odd size) are rotated, but this can be specified with a number before the move. For example, **3f** (or **3Fw**) rotates the first three front layers.

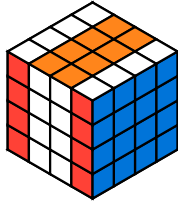
Just as before with the depth parameter, the maximum number of layers that can be moved with a wide move is equal to size - 1. A specific notations exists for rotating the entire cube that will be explained next.



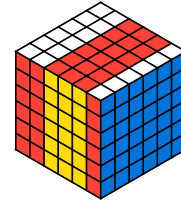
It is also possible to rotate multiple inner layers. To do so, write the first and last layers before the move separated with a dash.



2-3l / 2-3Lw



2-4r / 2-4Rw

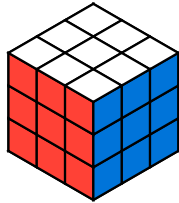


## III.4 Cube rotations

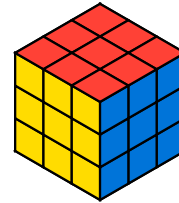
For a complete cube rotation the letters **x**, **y** and **z** are used. These movements do not alter the state of the cube, just the point of view.

- **x**: rotating the whole cube as if performing **R**.
- **y**: rotating the whole cube as if performing **U**.
- **z**: rotating the whole cube as if performing **F**.

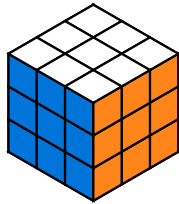
Original state



x



y



z



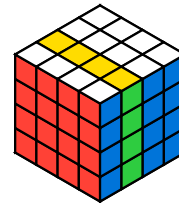
## III.5 Modifiers

Appending an apostrophe (') or a "2" to a move denotes a counterclockwise rotation or a double one (180°), respectively. These modifiers can be applied to any notation described above.

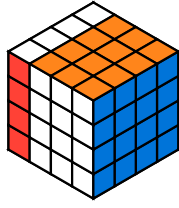
R'



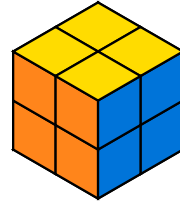
2F2



3Rw'



x2



# Part IV

## Reference

### IV.1 Custom types

#### IV.1.1 `face`

`face` is the type used throughout the package to refer to one of the six faces of the cube. It accepts the following `str` values:

- "f": for the **f**ront face.
- "r": for the **r**ight face.
- "u": for the **u**pper face.
- "b": for the **b**ack face.
- "l": for the **l**eft face.
- "d": for the **d**own face.

Face identifiers are lowercase and case-sensitive.

#### IV.1.2 `cube`

`cube` represents the complete state of a Rubik's cube, it is the main element in this package. However, you should not create or modify instances manually, as functions such as `#draw_cube` require the cube to be in a valid, consistent state. Instead, use `#cube` to create instances and `#apply` to manipulate them.

```
(  
  {size} number  
  {f} array of color  
  {r} array of color  
  {u} array of color  
  {b} array of color  
  {l} array of color  
  {d} array of color  
)
```

Each array must contain `{size}`<sup>2</sup> elements.

**IV.1.3** **cube-colors**

This type is used when creating a cube to specify the color of each face.

```
(
  {f} color
  {r} color
  {u} color
  {b} color
  {l} color
  {d} color
)
```

Not all keys need to be present for a valid **cube-colors** value.

**IV.1.4** **cube-stickers**

This type is used when creating a cube to specify the color of the stickers for each face. All the arrays must have the same length and it must be equal to the square of the size of the cube.

```
(
  {f} array of color
  {r} array of color
  {u} array of color
  {b} array of color
  {l} array of color
  {d} array of color
)
```

Not all keys need to be present for a valid **cube-stickers** value.

**IV.2 Functions**

|                   |                     |                      |
|-------------------|---------------------|----------------------|
| <b>#apply</b>     | <b>#draw_face</b>   | <b>#rotate_layer</b> |
| <b>#cube</b>      | <b>#draw_flat</b>   |                      |
| <b>#draw_cube</b> | <b>#rotate_cube</b> |                      |

**#apply**(**{cube}**, **{alg}**, **{inverted}**: **false**) → **cube**

Returns a new **cube** with an algorithm applied.

Argument

**{cube}**

**cube**

The cube to which the algorithm is applied.

Argument

`<alg>`

`str`

A string containing the algorithm to apply, following the notation specified in [Section III](#).

Argument

`<inverted>: false`

`bool`

If true, the inverse of the algorithm is applied. This is useful when documenting solution algorithms, which are intended to solve the resulting cube.

`#cube(<size>: 3, <colors>: auto, <stickers>: auto) → cube`

This function creates a `cube` given the size, colors, and/or stickers. This is the correct way to create `cube` instances.

The `<stickers>` argument lets you specify all the stickers on a face. Note that if a face is specified with this argument, it must be fully specified, and the corresponding entry in `<colors>` is ignored.

For each face present in `<stickers>`, the corresponding value in `<colors>` is ignored.

Argument

`<size>: 3`

`int`

The size of the cube. The default value is 3, i.e., a standard cube.

Argument

`<colors>: auto`

`cube-colors` | `auto`

The colors assigned to each face.

It must be a `cube-colors`, although it does not need to contain all the keys. In that case, the default color value will be used.

The default values for each face are:

```
(
  f: red,
  r: blue,
  u: white,
  b: orange,
  l: green,
  d: yellow
)
```

Argument

`{stickers}: auto``cube-stickers | auto`

The stickers of the cube. By default, the cube is initialized in the solved state. See [Section II.1](#) for more details and examples.

#`draw_cube(``{cube},``{x}: 35.264deg,``{y}: 45deg,``{z}: 0deg,``{length}: 60pt``) → content`

Draws a 3D representation of the cube.

The orientation can be modified with the `{x}`, `{y}` and `{z}` arguments. The default orientation is an isometric projection. For more details, see the [CETZ documentation<sup>2</sup>](#).

Argument

`{cube}``cube`

The cube to draw.

Argument

`{x}: 35.264deg``angle`

Rotation around the x-axis.

Argument

`{y}: 45deg``angle`

Rotation around the y-axis.

Argument

`{z}: 0deg``angle`

Rotation around the z-axis.

Argument

`{length}: 60pt``length`

The length of the side of the cube.

Note that it is different from the cube length. `{length}` specifies the length of **one cube edge before projection**.

<sup>2</sup><https://cetz-package.github.io/docs/api/draw-functions/projections/ortho>

```
#draw_face(
  {cube},
  {face},
  {up-face}: auto,
  {length}: 60pt,
  {lateral-faces}: true
) → content
```

Draws a single face of the cube, and optionally the first row of the adjacent faces.

Argument —  
 {cube} cube  
 The cube to draw.

Argument —  
 {face} face  
 The face to display.  
 It must be one of ("f", "r", "u", "b", "l", "d").

Argument —  
 {up-face}: auto face | auto  
 The face that will be displayed above the main face. It defines the orientation of the cube. If set to auto, the logical default is used:

- For "f", "r", "b" and "l": "u".
- For "u": "b".
- For "d": "f".

Valid values are auto and any face except the selected in {face} and its opposite.

Argument —  
 {length}: 60pt length  
 The length of the side of the cube.

Argument —  
 {lateral-faces}: true bool  
 Whether lateral faces will appear or not.

```
#draw_flat({cube}, {length}: 60pt) → content
```

Draws a flat representation of the cube.

Argument —  
 {cube} cube  
 The cube to draw.

Argument

`{length}: 60pt``length`

The length of the side of the cube.

#`rotate_cube`(`{cube}`, `{axis}`) → `cube`Returns a new `cube` rotated.

It returns the cube after applying the rotation. It is used for applying the rotations explained in [Section III.4](#).

Argument

`{cube}``cube`

The cube to apply the rotation.

Argument

`{axis}``str`

The axis around which the cube is rotated. Must be one of ("x", "y", "z").

#`rotate_layer`(`{cube}`, `{face}`, `{depth}: 1`, `{n}: 1`) → `cube`Returns a new `cube` with one layer rotated.

It returns the cube after applying the rotation. It is used for applying the 1-layer rotations explained in [Section III.1](#).

Argument

`{cube}``cube`

The cube to apply the rotation.

Argument

`{face}``face`

The face that defines the layer to rotate, must be one of ("f", "r", "u", "b", "l", "d").

Argument

`{depth}: 1``int`

The depth of the layer to rotate, by default 1, i.e., the outermost face.

It must be smaller than the cube size.

Argument

`{n}: 1``int`

The number of rotations to apply, by default 1.

#`f2l-cube``cube`

3x3x3 cube with only the first 2 layers colored. The upper layer is in gray color.



#oll-cube

cube

3x3x3 cube with only the upper face colored. The rest of the cube is in gray color.

#solved-cube

cube

3x3x3 solved cube.

# Part V

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